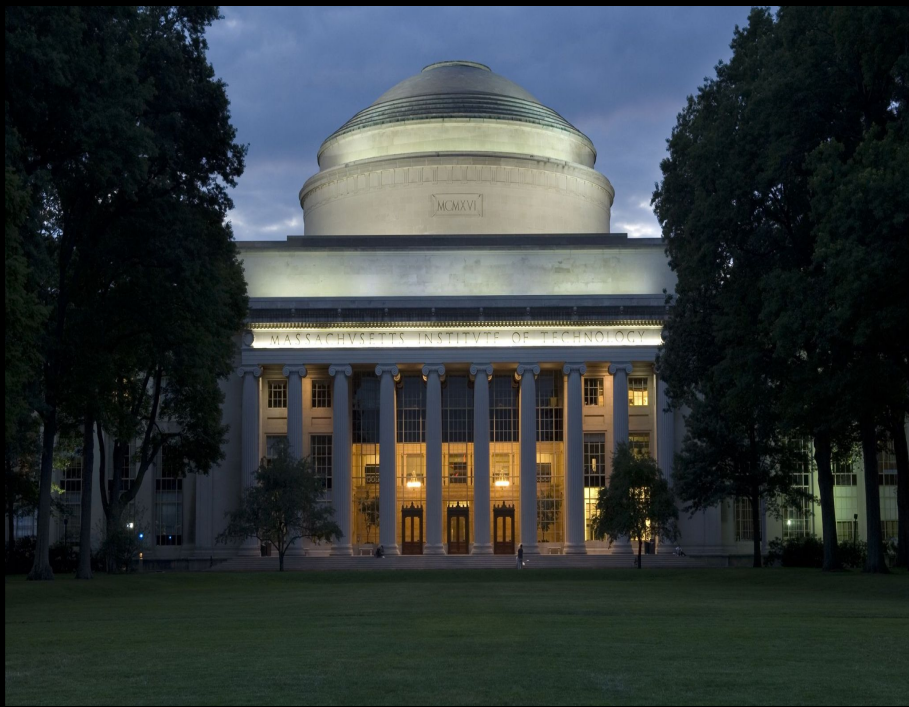


THE COLLEGE APPLICATION PROCESS

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DEFINITION OF TERMS

- **ED: Early Decision** - binding application option in November offered by most schools
- **SCEA/ REA**: Single Choice Early Action/ Restrictive Early Action - non-binding but restrictive application option in November offered by Harvard, Yale, Stanford and Princeton
- **EA: Early Action**: non-binding application option in November offered by some private schools (MIT, CalTech, Notre Dame, Georgetown) and mostly public schools
- **ED2: Early Decision 2**: binding application option in January offered by some private schools (JHU, Uchicago)
- **Regular Decision (RD)**: non-binding application option in January offered by **ALL** schools

DEFINITION OF TERMS

- **College** - a higher learning institution that offers undergraduate education e.g. Harvard college, Swarthmore college
- **Ivy League**: Eight schools that are part of an athletic conference i.e. Harvard, Yale, Princeton, Columbia, University of Pennsylvania, Cornell, Dartmouth and Brown
- **Liberal arts college** - A liberal arts college or liberal arts institution of higher education is a college with an emphasis on undergraduate study in the liberal arts and sciences.
- **Class Rank** - A measurement of how your academic achievement compares with that of other students in your grade. This number is usually determined by using a weighted GPA that takes into account both your grades and the difficulty of the courses you've taken.

DEFINITION OF TERMS

- **Grade Point Average (GPA)** - A number that shows overall academic performance. It's computed by assigning a point value to each grade you earn.
- **Need-Blind Admission** - A policy of making admission decisions without considering the financial circumstances of applicants. Colleges that use this policy may not offer enough financial aid to meet a student's full need.
- **Deferral** - Rather than rejecting good-fit students with strong profiles, applications are instead deferred to the regular round where they'll be reviewed again within the context of the regular applicant pool, as if they hadn't been reviewed previously.
- **Wait List** - College waitlists include qualified students who might be admitted if room in the class becomes available.

TIMELINE OF COLLEGE APPLICATIONS

June - September -- College Counselling Program

International Test Dates

SAT Test Dates:

1. August
2. October - Last for early round
3. December

ACT Test Dates:

1. July
2. September
3. October
4. December
5. February 2022

TIMELINE OF COLLEGE APPLICATIONS

1. Equity College Counselling Program - July - September
2. Early Round (EA/ED/REA/SCEA) - Early November
3. Early Round Decisions - Mid December
4. Regular Decision Deadlines - Late December/ Early January
5. Regular Decisions - Late March / Early April
6. Looking into waitlists if not satisfied with college admissions. - April - May **(Some schools' waitlists are active into the summer)**
7. Committing - Early May
8. Transition Camp - August
9. Move - in - September (Beginning of Fall)

INTRODUCTION TO THE COLLEGE APPLICATION PROCESS

- The college application process is by definition the process of applying to higher learning institutions abroad.

Application Requirements

1. Common App / Coalition / Schools Own App **(Includes the Personal Statement)**
2. College Supplements
3. Application fee (Fee Waiver)
4. SAT / ACT (Optional)
5. KCSE
6. School Report and high school transcript.
7. 2 Teacher Recommendations

PREPARING ESSAYS, SAT/ACT, EXTRACURRICULARS, RECOMMENDATION LETTERS

- You should begin preparing to write essays as early as now. **(The college counselling program will be geared towards refining your writing abilities)**
- You should also get in touch with teachers who you would want to assist you (recommendation letters) and your school counselor or another school official to serve in that capacity.
- Start prepping for SAT /ACT if you wish to take them as early as now.
- There are many online resources that'll be shared as we progress that should help one be able to write and refine essays.
- Your CC Mentor should be able to review your essays and guide you accordingly.

RESEARCHING COLLEGES / COLLEGE LIST



- Finding the right colleges to apply to is an important task.
- One should be able to prepare a sound and manageable college list.

Researching about colleges.

1. Google
2. Official college websites.
3. Social media
4. Quora
5. Reddit

Tips for making a college list:

1. Consider Financial Aid
2. Only Apply to Schools You'd Actually Like to Attend
3. Find Your Best Fit

RESEARCHING COLLEGES / COLLEGE LIST

- The first step in tackling the college search process involves thinking about what you want out of your college experience.

Primary Factors

1. Cost.
2. Location.
3. Size.
4. Academics.

Secondary Factors

1. Social scene
2. Housing
3. Dining
4. Extracurriculars
5. Athletics

RESEARCHING COLLEGES / COLLEGE LIST

A1 fx SCHOOL						
	A	B	C	D	E	F
1	SCHOOL	AID	CSS PROFILE	SELF REPORTING	CSS WAIVER	APP WAIVER
2	Amherst	Yes	Yes 3003	Yes	https://admission.amherst.edu/register/css-profilefee waiver2021	Yes Normal
3	Brown	Yes	Yes 3401	Yes	No (Confirmed)	Yes Normal
4	Colby	Yes	Yes 3280	Yes	No	Yes Free to apply
5	Columbia	Yes	Yes 2116	Yes	ugrad-finaid@columbia.edu	Yes Normal
6	Cornell	Yes	Yes 2098	Yes	intl-finaid@cornell.edu	Yes Normal
8	Duke	Yes	Yes	Yes	No	Yes Normal
9	Johns Hopkins	Yes	Yes	Yes	No	Yes Normal
10	Northwestern	Yes	ISFAA	Yes	ISFAA	Yes Normal
11	Pomona	Yes	ISFAA	Yes	ISFAA	Yes Normal

REGISTER FOR INTERVIEWS AND COLLEGE INFO. SESSIONS

- Around late July, colleges will offer information sessions about admissions, financial aid, and even personal conversations with admission officers.
- These information sessions are a chance to learn more about what the colleges are looking for right from the admission officers, demonstrate interest, and if possible introduce yourselves to admission officers.
- Due to the COVID-19 pandemic, some liberal arts colleges and universities will require you to schedule your own interviews. Some of these colleges are Bates college, Washington University in St. Louis and Lafayette college.

CSS PROFILE FILLING & REGISTERING FOR AND TAKING SAT/ACT



- On August 1st, you should create a Collegeboard account (about the same time you open your Common App).
- Once created, you will be able to access the College Scholarship Service (CSS) profile and the SAT registration page (optional).

CSS PROFILE FILLING & REGISTERING FOR AND TAKING SAT/ACT

- Once you access the CSS profile, speak with your parents to provide the necessary information and fill the CSS profile before November.
- For the ACT, visit the website my.act.org and create an account. From here you can register for the ACT.
- If you decide to take the SAT or ACT, try to take the exams by October, which means you should register by September.
- **Side note:** The SAT subject tests are no longer available, the SAT costs around Kshs. 15,000 and the ACT costs around Kshs. 18,000

THE EARLY APPLICATION (ED, SCEA, REA, EA)

- You've been preparing your essays, recommendations, taken standardized tests (optional) and selected an early admissions college, and it is now time to send the applications.
- At least a week before your submission deadline, request for a fee waiver for the CSS profile from your early admission college (some don't offer so check with your school) and submit your CSS profile before the deadline.
- Submit your application before midnight the day it's due i.e. if the deadline is November 1st submit by 11:59pm November 1st. Go through your app before submission

THE EARLY APPLICATION (ED, SCEA, REA, EA)

- Make sure your teachers and recommenders have sent in their recommendations. Some colleges will give your recommenders a grace period

WHICH COLLEGE ADMISSION PROCESS BEST SUITS YOU?				
Nonrestrictive Application Plans			Restrictive Application Plans	
Regular Decision	Rolling Admission	Early Action (EA)	Early Decision (ED)	Restrictive Early Action (REA)
DEFINITION: Students submit an application by a specified date and receive a decision in a clearly stated period of time.	DEFINITION: Institutions review applications as they are submitted and render admission decisions throughout the admission cycle.	DEFINITION: Students apply early and receive a decision well in advance of the institution's regular response date.	DEFINITION: Students make a commitment to a first-choice institution where, if admitted they definitely will enroll. The application deadline and decision deadline occur early.	DEFINITION: Students apply to an institution of preference and receive a decision early. They may be restricted from applying ED or EA or REA to other institutions. If offered enrollment, they have until May 1 to confirm.
COMMITMENT: NONBINDING	COMMITMENT: NONBINDING	COMMITMENT: NONBINDING	COMMITMENT: BINDING	COMMITMENT: NONBINDING
Students are not restricted from applying to other institutions and have until May 1 to consider their options and confirm enrollment.			Students are responsible for determining and following restrictions.	

EARLY ADMISSION DECISIONS AND REGULAR DECISION / EARLY DECISION 2 SUBMISSIONS

- After submitting your Early Admission applications, you should continue preparing essays for Regular Decision.
- Around mid to late December, Early Admission decisions will be released.
- If admitted with ample financial aid, commit and enjoy your Christmas.
- If rejected, complete your Regular Decision essays and submit them. Unlike Early Admission you will have an option to submit more applications (you can submit up to 19 more on the Common App).
- If deferred, you will have to write a letter of continued interest and also complete your Regular Admission essays.

EARLY ADMISSION DECISIONS AND REGULAR ADMISSION / EARLY DECISION 2 SUBMISSIONS

- Regular Decision applications will not require you to submit new recommendations. The uploaded recommendations will still be available for Regular Admission.
- Regular Admission deadlines run from January 1st to February 1st with most deadlines being around early January so start your essays early.
- Also kindly request for CSS Profile fee waivers from your schools early to save you money.

REGULAR DECISION INTERVIEWS AND FINANCIAL AID

- After submitting your Regular Decision applications, check with your schools for the CSS profile submission deadlines. Most CSS profile deadlines for Regular decision come after application submission.
- From Mid-January to March, some of the colleges that you applied to will require or ask that you participate in an interview (please do!). If a college asks for you to schedule your interview, schedule early because slots fill up quickly.

EARLY DECISION 2 DECISIONS

- From around Mid-February to March, Early Decision 2 colleges will release their decisions.
- If admitted, commit and withdraw your Regular Decision applications.
- If deferred, write a letter of continued interest and keep in contact with your admission officer.

REGULAR DECISION RELEASE

- Probably the most tense period.
- You will receive admission decisions from all the schools you applied to.
- If you receive several admission packages, celebrate, weigh your options and pick a college to attend.
- If you do not receive admissions but get waitlisted, write a letter of continued interest and email your admission officers.
- Inform Equity about your decision and enjoy your summer holiday as you prepare to leave!

WAITLISTED STUDENTS



- If you are still on a waitlist that you want to pursue, keep constant communication with your admission officer (don't burden them of course) and commit to your second choice school.
- Contrary to popular belief waitlists are not rejections and if you're lucky you may be admitted.
- Admission from waitlists begins in April and can drag on to August, even though most waitlists are closed by July.

Q & A

ANY QUESTIONS?